issues they became even less interested in waging a bloody liberation struggle. Several interlocutors from Indian-administered Kashmir also observed that while anger at India remained potent, many people were simply fed up with the militants by this point. That local factors contributed to stability does not nullify Pakistani attempts to decrease violence there. Most Indian interlocutors agreed that Musharraf's efforts were a major driver in the reduction of violence. As one Indian analyst said, 'to give the devil his due, he was making a real effort.'[29] Indeed, by 2006 Pakistan's efforts were deemed significant enough to merit considering reciprocity. A modest troop withdrawal from Indian-administered Kashmir was mooted that year, but it was not to the scale Islamabad sought. The Indian government also wanted to handle the issue via private negotiations and balked when Pakistan pushed publicly for major demilitarization.[30]

Meanwhile Pakistan remained unprepared to abandon the Kashmir jihad entirely: first, because doing so would rob the country of leverage; and second, because closing down the Kashmir jihad completely would have internal repercussions in terms of Pakistan's relations with those militants who remained committed to this front. The army and ISI continued to encourage small numbers of militants to cross the LoC and directed others to use alternative routes to reach Indian-administered Kashmir. The aforementioned journalist who was reporting from Pakistan-administered Kashmir at the time asserted that Brigadier-rank officers were sent to the LoC to make sure launchings stayed low, but not to end them entirely.[31] Current and former Lashkar sources confirm the army allowed small numbers of militants to attempt to cross the LoC. Soldiers and ISI officers also sometimes provided necessary intelligence, including identifying locations conducive to infiltration.[32] According to one civil servant in Indian-administered Kashmir, controllers operating on the Pakistani side of the LoC also continued to dictate targeting instructions to their commanders in the field.[33] Most of those infiltrating still came across the LoC, but Indian sources assert that Lashkar infiltrated small numbers of militants into India via Nepal, Bangladesh or by sea, after which they would attempt to make their way to Indian-administered Kashmir.[34] The fact that Lashkar cadres went to this trouble is notable not only in light of the alleged directive to use alternative routes. It also illustrates the depth of Lashkar's commitment to the Kashmir jihad. However, it should be noted that some